Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: February 28, 2024 6:30-8:30 pm

"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.
They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.
Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."

Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

A school council is an advisory body that functions within the parameters of Ministry of Education and Board policy. School councils provide an opportunity and the means to advise the principal and the Board on any matter pertaining to improvement of pupil achievement and enhancing the accountability of the education system to parents/guardians. The ultimate responsibility for the administration and management of the day-to-day operation of the school rests with the principal.

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome** - In-person Attendance: Treasure, Tara, Alison, Ling, Jason, Kathleen, Amy, Irina, Lindsay, Heather, Henriette, Shaun, Alissa - Regrets: K. Murphy		Chair
2	**Council Housekeeping** - Revisit of Role of Council & accountability of the Agenda schedule. Emphasis on supporting School Admin & enriching the School environment. Reminder to submit topics for discussion to Council email. Chair will append networking notes & send agenda for Council members to review prior to the next meeting to bring specific questions. Questions during meetings are encouraged, but need to be on topic regarding items under the prevue of Council. - January meeting minutes approved & posted to website Future Council Dates - March 13 – No meeting - April 17 (revised date since April 10 is PD Day) - May 8 - June 12	5 mins	Council Members
3	**News**		
	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com	5 mins	SNA Representative (Kathleen)

	- For more information please email programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com - March Break Camp full (waitlist available). - Older Adult programs offerings on Wednesdays with rotating activities posted online each week. - Online summer camp registration starts March 21 (8am) for children 5+. Q: What is the limitation for the Junior camp (5-7-yrs). Parents needing clarification should contact SNA. - LIT registration closed but event opportunities still available on event basis. - Neighbourhood Day (Jun 8, 1pm-4pm). Q: Would Council want a table? A: Vote deferred to April meeting. - Silverheights PS requested if SNA would be willing to participate in the Earth Rangers-operated battery recycling program. Box and brochure provided to SNA.		
	WRAPC/PIC https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/ https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/ - Meeting notes should be provided to Chair for distribution to Council members to review prior to meeting. - Specific questions to the WRAPC rep as needed. - StrongStart reading program to resume following pause to align with Ministry curriculum. Treasure has been contacted for Silverheights PS. - Next WRAPC topic will be focused on Individual Education Plans (IEPs). Questions should be forwarded to Amy to table at next WRAPC meeting. - Q: On WRDSB PD days, how does School Admin adjust Professional Development to be inclusive across the grade categories & IEP/neurodivergent students? A: Flex feedback from educators within the school & also guidance provided from WRDSB.	10 mins	Assembly Rep (A. Pharoah)
	Teacher Updates - *See notes provided under Principal's Report*	10 mins	Teacher Rep - regrets
4	**Principal's Report** - Earth Rangers special guest assembly was well received; Guests brough reptiles, discussed climate change, & overall student response & engagement was positive. Primary teachers made curriculum links with energized students. School to participate in battery recycling collection program. - Black Brilliance month focused on Canadian representation. Students created posters & posted in the hallways. Teachers brough classes to visit the posters to initiate discussions. Student work made into a slideshow with a random draw for a class pizza party. - Sports: Girl & Boys intermediate basketball team made it to semifinals. Track & Field to start this spring - Ongoing clubs + new Karoke club	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)

	- Gr8 Celebration plans finalized. Student driven & researched based on Teacher-lead directives. Follow-up will be provided to Council at April or May meeting. - Continuing Nutrition For Learning (NFL) bracelet fundraiser underway. - Kindie Open House ongoing. - Report Cards were sent home last week. Only one mark issued for math and language (no more strands). Link for parent resource to learn about the one mark language mark on the report card https://www.dcp.edu.gov.on.ca/en/language-guide - Parents should contact their teachers directly to schedule time to discuss their student progress. ETFO contract does not mandate formal Parent-Teacher interviews. - Environment Club considering a fundraising campaign; leaving up to club & supervising teacher to coordinate. - School approved for eco-forest improvement funding. Spring tree & shrub planting planned behind portables where the long-jump pit currently located (new long jump to be constructed). Native plant list requested by parent. School admin looking for volunteers from Council & parent community to help maintain new plantings during the summer. SNA offers LITs to volunteer for summer plant maintenance, if needed.		
5	**Equity Connection** ***Words matter*** *(*workshop for Gr 6 & 7) - Purpose - Bring awareness to the Council that the Words Matter initiative is continuing this year with Gr 7 students facilitating the learning to Gr 6 & 7 classes. - Student led initiative to revisit microaggression. Presentation raises consciousness about racialized insults. General observations that current Intermediate grade have improved inclusive language. ***Youth Symposium*** - Not all Gr8 classes selected to participate. Silverheights will be in attendance. Purpose - Request Council funds to subsidize admission fee for the Youth Symposium (Galaxy movie theatre in Waterloo) for families that are not able to pay. Cost $15/student. Transportation for this covered by the bussing allocation already approved by Council (Gr8 field trip). Q: What is the theme? Host by Scott Hamil, SADVTC. “Overcoming hard times”. ***Book Club*** - Ongoing with positive feedback since half the participants returned from last year. Currently Gr 7 & 8, with select Gr. 6 students.	10 min	Vice-Principal (T. Goudy)
6	**Financial Report** - Accounting is maintained by school admin (Head Secretary) for council funds.	15 min	Treasurer

- See attached Treasures report.
- Total expenditures = -$29,365.31
- Total Council approved allocated expenses = -$16,799.22
- Estimated available funds for allocation = $3,726.61
  (Estimated available funds assumes fundraising monies from average costs associated with remaining Pizza Days to end of school year.)

Proposals:

- Washer/Dry Replacement for ACE club
  Purpose – For life skill development for ACE club. Not part of facilities budget - $2000
  VOTE: APPROVED
- Dash Coding Robot kits for ages 6-11 (grade 2-4),
  Purpose - Hands-on tools to learn basic and more advanced coding - $1581.94 - 5 item OR $269 FOR 1 UNIT
  Students will learn curriculum-based coding concepts. Robots use free and approved apps and will work with existing school technology
  https://www.makewonder.com/dash/
  Supporting document: Parent Council Proposal - Better Coding Robots
  https://docs.google.com/document/d/1_6fq4PifgxTapdmXF6yAtLbrSGXKf6OodmzJPY7kthQ/edit
  Vote on this was deferred for this item in January
  VOTE: APPROVED FOR 2 UNITS ($550)
- Mop proposal (Custodial staff)
  Purpose - request funding to purchase for classroom communities for students to use instead of paper towels. Also facilitate life skill building - $1009.92 - 23 mops, 4 packs of 10 reusable pads - pilot area
  Document: Mop Proposal - Donna King.pdf
  https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ZC_KMgScxiZws5yMSbvTJqQD3Gt1RhqQ/view?usp=sharing
  VOTE: APPROVED
- Deferred Music Program Proposals – voting at end of school year based on remaining funds. Follow-up needed to confirm # of instruments
  - 15 Acoustic + case = $2,700
  - 15 Yamaha keyboards = $3000

Grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-Funds.pdf

- In future we should be focusing on the PRO and PIC Grants beginning in October
- PIC Grant - $500 allocated annually.
- PRO Grant: Awarded $500
- Funds for both grants to be used to support the Equity Connections Book Club (This Book Is Anti-Racist).

7	**Fundraising Committee Update** - Review of fundraising goals ***Pizza Subcommittee:*** - Excess COVID supplies of gloves & paper towels diminishing. This expense is General School expense; Council should not need to expense back to the school. - Volunteers request 2 boxes of gloves to be placed on the cart. - # Pizza Days completed = 20/34 - # Pizza Days remain to end of school year= 14 (Last day Jun 18) - Estimated total funds spent by community on Pizza Days to date = $33,550 (~$48/student, based on 700 students) - Other pizza vendors interested in participating in school fundraising. PizzaPizza meet with School admin with proposal. - Council consensus to continue with current vendor (Domino's) based on: providing consistent product, meets WRDSB nutrition program, & community support. - **ACTION:** School Admin to request total funds in the "Give-a-slice" program. Historically the school community is "giving" more than needed). Tally of funds to be made by next meeting to determine if Council should pause the program to go through the funds. ▪ The Give-a-slice/Need-a-slice program continues to be a success. ▪ Starting Balance - 200 slices of given pizza slices leftover from last year ▪ We have been breaking even most weeks when comparing the number of slices given vs. the number of slices needed. ▪ There continues to be a need to have the "give a slice" option and a google form requesting financial assistance. The google form has shown there is a greater number of people self-identifying as requiring support ▪ Overall, this program has been a success based on the generosity of our community, as well as the trust that folks have in us to self identify as needing financial assistance. Students are receiving a hot lunch with their peers and we know that we are taking care of our community every week with this program. Current fundraising campaigns: - Mabels Labels (Kindie Classrooms, ongoing) - Oliver's Labels (ongoing school-wide) http://www.oliverslabels.com/silverheightsps - Domino's Pizza (Wednesdays, Promo code: CARE, ongoing) - NEW & future campaign: Domino's Pizza (Feb 25-29; Jun 2-6), Promo code: FUND, 50% of sales to School.	15 mins	Subcommittee Rep

8	**Special Events Committee**: 2024 Community Activity Fair - Please see the attached email summary for planning proposal. - Subcommittee met with School Admin & Chair after adjournment for clarification on planning items. See attached notes from subcommittee meeting that occurred after Council meeting adjournment. - School admin provide update on WRDSB rules for "Community Use". -	0 mins	Assembly Rep
9	Questions & Answer Period - Setting up Band in Music Class – Pictures	10 mins	Council Members
10	Next Meeting Date:	April 17, 2024	In-person & online meet
11	Agenda Items for Next Meeting - Last call for proposals - EcoForest plant list & summer maintenance schedule for volunteers - School Admin to request total funds in the "Give-a-slice" program. Historically the school community is "giving" more than needed). Tally of funds to be made by next meeting to determine if Council should pause the program to go through the funds. - Special Events Subcommittee proposal		Council Members
12	Adjournment		

Notes:
MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education
PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)
PRO – Parents Reaching Out
SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)
WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)
General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

WRAPSC Update Feb. 2024 Amy Pharoah

- literacy night for parent to help support the new literacy curriculum
- k to 6 school has book fairs; funds used to replace and renew our home reading books
- Staff member to speak to council about new literacy curriculum
- School uses Lexia to support teachers.
- Changes to new Ontario Literacy Curriculum podcast a school suggested: https://madlylearning.com/ontariolanguagecurriculum2023/#:~:text=The%20new%20Ontario%20langauge%20curriculum,about%20diversifying%20how%20we%20teach

Speakers:

- Bobbie Chatha System Administrator Learning Services-Elementary Program, JK-8
- Lindsay O'Donoghue Learning Support Services Program and Curriculum Consultant
- Kim Templeton Learning Support Services Program and Curriculum Consultant

Old Literacy Method:

- skip a word and come back
- Think about what makes sense
- Look at the pictures to figure out a word (doesn't work)

Helpful Literacy Links

- Elementary Literacy Google Group
- 6 Part Literacy Learning Series
- UFLI D2L course
- Heggerty, Kilpatrick, Sound Wall D2L courses
- Junior Reading Learning Series

Helpful French Links

- French Phonological Awareness/Phonics/Sound Wall D2L course
- Pratique Phonemique: Phonemic Awareness
- I Can Read in French: Phonics
- Engaging Strategies in the FSL Classroom D2L course

Helpful Math Links:

- WRDSB Math LRP Resource
- Just in Time PD
- Comprehensive Math D2L course
- MathUp Orientation
- Dreambox Support

Helpful Kindergarten Link

- Kindergarten Foundations website

New Literacy Method:

Right to Read made 157 recommendations to school boards, faculty in curriculum, screening, intervention, accommodations, and assessment

There is a teacher's guide (Spring 2022)

PD training for teachers:

- Yr. 1-2 Plan: Phonological Awareness, sight recognition (memorized set of words), and decoding (books that use only words that child knows and has been taught (to reinforce knowledge)
    - Syllables
    - Phonemes (phonetic sounds)
    - Decoding (which sounds match to which letters)
    - Sight recognition (familiar words)
- Yr 2-4: Oral fluency, background knowledge, vocabulary (prefixes and suffixes of words), language structures, verbal reasoning, literacy knowledge
- Year 4-5: Reading comprehension

Grade 7-9 working on reading skills in classrooms

Humans use multiple regions of the brain to read

65K students in WRDSB

New Structured Literacy Learning for Kids:

- Phonemic Awareness
- Phonics: sound to letters
- Word Reading
- Spelling
- Fluency
- Vocabulary
- Listening & Reading comprehension
- Written expression

How they teach:

- Sequentially
- Explicitly: practice sounds
- Systematic: applying new learning to new steps
- Cumulative: repeated practice
- Diagnostic: checking in and monitoring
- Early universal screening

In the Classroom

- To develop oral language: get kids to talk, listen, and interact and connect to reading
- Reading

- Spelling words
- Letter sounds

Teachers: Acadience screening tool will be used next year definitely; voluntarily now

Ufly: aligns with structured literacy

Older Grades:

- Reading longer words
- Syllables
- Prefixes ie. The prefix “a” means “without” or “not” so **a**naemic means “**without** any energy”
- Suffixes ie suffixes: -ful, -ment, -ism: “hope**ful**,” “acknowledge**ment**,” “capital**ism**”
- Coaches work with Gr. 7-9

How can Parent Councils Support Schools with new shift?

- Magnetic letters
- Magnetic board to make different words
- Whiteboards and whiteboard markers
- Decodable texts
- Home reading: focus on background knowledge; share book together; especially non fiction books can create background knowledge to kids
- Keep purchasing home reading books

On report card, will see “early reading screening yes or no”. This year will say “no” because it isn’t reported until next year.

Diagnostic: older kids

K-2: screener

Staff member should come to council and discuss new reading curriculum

Apr. WRAPSC meeting will discus spec Ed and IEPS. Let me know any questions you have to bring up.

Concerns brought up by councils:

- How to hold a PRO grant joint event when school building is not allowing its use (WRDSB board room available but unsure of sizing: Cambridge Room is possibly the name)
- How to tell parents that school councils are running pizza? Use School Day recommended, but WRAPSC executive team member warned that admins change wording of School Day messages; Michelle Newlands (board representative) said to CC Superintendent when sending the principal a School Day message to be sent out if this is happening.

Michelle Newlands is present at every WRAPSC meeting sharing concerns with the board of WRAPSC members

- PRO grant CC to chairs of grant approval came from Michelle’s direction at a WRAPSC member’s request

RESOURCES FOR ACBI FAMILIES

WATERLOO REGIONAL DISTRICT SCHOOL BOARD

- System Navigator for Anti-racism & ACBi focus
  phyllis_pephra@wrdsb.ca
- Equity & Inclusion Officer teneile_warren@wrdsb.ca
- Superintendent for parent engagement
  michelle_newlands@wrdsb.ca
- Board of Trustees Vice chair maedith_radlein@wrdsb.ca

REGIONAL NON-PROFIT ORGANIZATIONS

- Rhythm & Blues https://www.rhythmbluescambridge.com/
- Kind Minds Family Wellness
  https://kindmindsfamilywellness.org/
- Caribbean Canadian Association of Waterloo Region
  https://www.ccawr.ca/
- KW multicultural. https://kwmulticultural.ca/

COMMUNITY GROUPS IN THE CKW REGION

- Black Parent Council kwblackparentcouncil@gmail.com
- KW tutoring BPC. kwtutoringbpc@gmail.com
- Blackbook of Waterloo Region
  https://theblackbookwr.wixsite.com/bbwr/home-1

Prepared by the Safe, Caring and Inclusive Schools team ,
A sub-committee of the Parent Involvement Committee of WRDSB

PIC celebrates Black W.O.W. (Women of Wonder)

Presented by WRDSB
Parent Involvement Committee

BLACK HISTORY MONTH

- Black history month was officially recognized in Canada in 1995 in the House of Commons.

- The motion was introduced by Dr. Jean Augustine who is one of our Women Of Wonder.

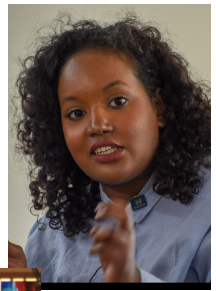
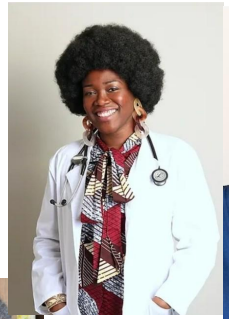
- Each year, there has been a different theme and the theme for 2024 is “Black Excellence”.

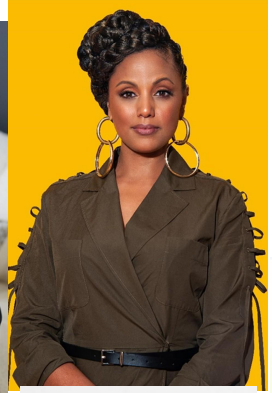
BLACK W.O.W. (WOMEN OF WONDER)

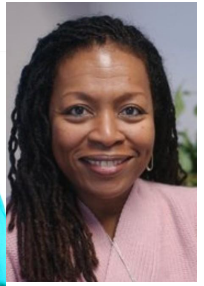
- PIC has created a series of social media posts and biographies celebrating black Canadian women.

- This series celebrates some of the notable black women who have contributed to Canada's past, present and future.

- Many of these women have broken glass ceilings to become the first black woman or the first black person in their field in Canada or in their home province.

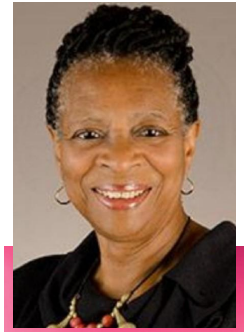





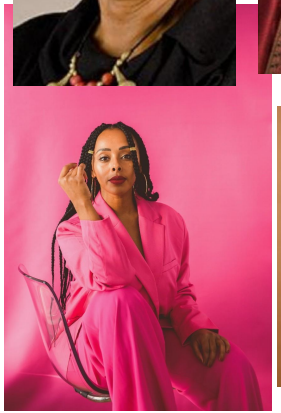
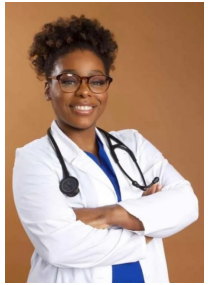











BLACK W.O.W (WOMEN OF WONDER)

- Many of these women of wonder represent intersectional identities

- Some are immigrants or born to immigrant parents. Many are multiethnic eg. Afro-Latina, Inuk-Jamaican. Some live with visible and invisible disabilities.

- They have all excelled in their fields of academia, performing arts, medicine, law, politics, social justice, community advocacy and activism.

- Through their work, they are all champions of human rights in Canada and that's why they are our focus for black history month..

PIC

- Contact info:

  Website: https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/

  Email : pic@wrdsb.ca

- Social Media:

  Facebook: WRDSBPIC

  Instagram: @pic_wrdsb

  X (Twitter): @PicWRDSB

Get involved!

- Join PIC as a PIC Member
- Attend a PIC Meeting
- Volunteer to be on PIC working groups
- Attend PIC Events
- Attend a WRAPSC meeting, on behalf of your School Council
- Offer suggestions, concerns, information to the PIC committee

Silverheights Public School

Financial report February 28, 2024

	Debit	Credit	Total	Notes
Carryforward 2022/2023				
Carry over (school events)		$ 6,339.69		
Total Carryforward:			**$6,339.69**	
Income 2023				
Pizza Sales- School day		#########	**$32,392.75**	
PROJECTED Income 2024				**Estimated forecast**
Pizza Sales- School Day		########		14 days remaining, 839 slices avg, $0.95 *pr*
				20 of 34 pizza days completed
Total PROJECTED Income:			***$43,551.45***	
Expenditures				
Domino's Pizza	#########			Cost for Pizza days (including Mar 5)
Words Matter t-shirts	$ (1,199.88)			Approved Spring 2023
Gym shirts	$ (850.25)			Approved Sept 2023
Special- Ed Sensory Room	$ (259.94)			Approved Sept 2023- Sensory chairs, fidget
Kalimbas for Music Class	$ (628.28)			Approved Nov 2023
School spirit t-shirts	$ (111.59)			Approved Nov 2023
Visual timers	$ (107.87)			Approved Dec 2023
Long & McQuade	$ (8,060.00)			Approved Dec 2023 Guitars, base/amp
Total expenditures:			**-$29,365.31**	
Allocations				
ACE field trips (2+)	$ (400.00)			Approved Nov 2023
Field Trip Transportation	$ (7,500.00)			Approved Nov 2023- 1 for every class
Grade 8 Hoodies	$ (400.00)			Approved Nov 2023- for anyone who needs
Grade 8 Celebration	$ (5,000.00)			Approved Nov 2023
Washer/Dryer	$ (2,000.00)			Approved Feb 2023
Mops	$ (1,009.00)			Approved Feb 2023
Dash coding robots (2)	$ (490.22)			Approved Feb 2023
Total Allocations:			**-$16,799.22**	
Total available funds:			**$3,726.61**	*Projected estimate budget remaining*
Grand total on School Funds report Dec 2023:			**$19,604.76**	

Proposals deferred from January meeting:

blockley or wonder (free apps). Age 6-11 learn ciriculum based coding. download app- control and program these coding robots used for math and solving real world problems. Five sets gives 1 device to 4 student ratio $1400+tax

Grade 8 Admission $15 for Youth Symposium: Child Witness Center topics include 'facing adversity', 'healthy dating relationships', & 'overcoming hard times'

Music Program - Delayed purchase of Soundtrap due to technology issues. Will this be purchased this school year?
Compostable gloves will be bought for students to use, comes out of school council profit budget

Allocated items that have been purchased:

Gym shirts	$ (1,500.00)			Approved Sept 2023
Special-Ed Sensory Room	$ (2,500.00)			Approved Sept 2023
Kalimbas for Music Class	$ (1,050.00)			Approved Nov 2023
Stove for Staff Room	$ -			Approved Nov 2023. Donated
Ice Maker	$ -			Approved Nov 2023. Donated
Guitars, base/amp	$ (8,550.00)			Approve Dec 2023
Visual timers (4)	$ (180.75)			Approved Dec 2023
Total			$ (13,780.75)	

Proposals for February meeting:

Washer/dryer for ACE it broke, tried to fix it, can't fix it anymore $2000 for both. Need to be stackable, checking with Da
Dash coding robot kids want 5 kits $1581.94 (this is instead of the cubelets) idea to have 1 or 2 bought
Mop proposal from Donna for classrooms for $1000

Deferred until year end:

Keyboards $3000
Acoustic guitars $2700

Special Event Subcommittee Meeting Minutes

Wed. February 28, 2024

Recorded by Alison Chong

Event: Activity fair

Event Objective? To connect the Silverheights PS (& greater Hespeler community?) to local vendors (non-profit & profit-based) who offer after-school programming (tutoring, extra-curriculars, sport, & various STEAM topics), PD day camps, & summer day camps.
School Admin: Clarification on attendees of this event must be clarified (Family & friends of school or community?).

- If this is a community event, then Council should not take on the liability of organizing the event & reach out to SNA to solicit interest to help coordinate. If Silverheights PS gym to be used, Subcommittee needs to apply for community use for facility use permit and procurement to use the school/gym as a community event space. Space would need to be rented with custodial staff is required for weekend school permits. Other venue options available if this event is no longer associated with Council (e.g the Legion (rented out), SNA at St Gabriel's?)
- If this is a school event, approval of School Admin needed to coordinate custodial staff with no additional costs as WRDSB would consider this event as providing a service to the Silverheights PS community. Principal and VP need to be in attendance & vendor list needs to be approved by the School Admin (to meet the school mandate).

Proposed Location: Silverheights PS gym
School Admin feedback: Gym, front lobby, & access to washrooms across from gym. Vendors cannot be in the library. Barricade to prevent public access to kinder hallway & other parts of school to protect student personal belongings.

Proposed date of Apr 27: Gym not available - volleyball tournament already booked
Alternate date of April 13: Gym is available

- Table fee for securing the spot in the gym provides accountability for them to show up (cannot do table charges) Depends on what you are calling it, and reason you are hosting it. If they are marketing their service to our community ie anyone who is for profit, they are coming to market their business so you cannot make money off community event. BUT if they are paying the school as part of a fundraiser then you can charge
- Filtered through WEFI logged (optional donation) ie. Paid marketing
- Then you can charge table fees etc but those need to be specific what they are going towards
- Can rent tables through the board if it's a school event

ACTON:

The event objective must be clarified as school-related or community-based. This will determine path of planning & need for Council approval. This decision is needed by next week in consultation with School Admin.

If this is a community event, then this topic will be marked as closed on the Council agenda.

If it is a school event & endorsed by School Admin, the Subcommittee will need to table this event to Council for approval (Google form). Informational vote needs to go to council as soon as possible, finalized at a meeting with admin. Upon receipt of Council approval, Subcommittee will need to meet with School Admin to finalize date, tables, & schedule, & review vendor list.